MATT CANDLER
New Orleans, LA
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MBA-trained energy educator with 25 years in learning innovation and 10 years in distributed energy and electrification

EDUCATION

1996 - 1998 **NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY** Evanston, IL
MBA, June 1998. Education Management, Managerial Economics / Decision Sciences. Dean's Service Award.

1988 - 1992 **DUKE UNIVERSITY** Durham, NC
BA, Mathematics and Spanish Language, May 1992. Dean's List. Photo Editor, *The Chronicle*.
Study Abroad, Madrid, Spain.

EXPERIENCE

2022 - Present **MY NEXT ELECTRIC** – Founder New Orleans, LA
- Experimental learning community for adults interested in electrifying their vehicles and homes
- Rapid iteration over 10 cohorts in wide variety of learning formats
- Latest offering: 2-hour e-bike conversion workshop to introduce fundamentals of electrification

2022 - Present **SOFT SKILLS FOR HARD TECH** – Founder New Orleans, LA
- Leadership training for technical founders and leaders in transition
- Global All-Star Mentor, Techstars EnergyTech, 2022
- Innovation Advisor, Entergy KeyString Labs, 2023

2019 - Present **BATTERIES INCLUDED FUND** – General Partner New Orleans, LA
- Angel through Series A investments in energy storage and adjacent technologies
- *Park Bench Pitch* founder/investor series: NYC Climate Week 2024, DERVOS 2025

2012 - Present **NIGHT SHIFT BIKES** – Founder New Orleans, LA
- EV conversions of vintage gas motorcycles and cars featured in TV, books, magazines, and online
- Electrified 1969 Fiat 500 awarded Best in Class, 2026 Tulane Formula Racing Annual Car Show

2010 - 2019 **4.0** – Founder, CEO New Orleans, LA
- Early-stage education incubator's 2,000+ alumni have leveraged $2B in follow-on funding and revenue.
- 18M students impacted in 14,600 schools in 47 states

1998 - 2022 **CANDLER CONSULTING LLC** – President New Orleans, LA
- Strategic planning and founder search for Vela Education Fund, 2019
- Instructor, Teacher Leader & Executive Leader Academies, Las Vegas Education Foundation, 2019-2020
- Instructor, Rice University Education Entrepreneurship Program, Jones Graduate School of Business, 2009-2010

2006 - 2009 **NEW SCHOOLS FOR NEW ORLEANS** – CEO New Orleans, LA
- Key player in most dramatic improvement in public education in a generation
- Raised $50M+ of philanthropy & established partnerships in school launch, governance, talent
- Co-created Leading for Excellence school founder training with Nancy Euske, Haas School of Business

2004 - 2006 **NYC CHARTER CENTER** – COO New York, NY
- Designed first citywide charter school incubator in U.S.
- First-of-a-kind public-private partnership with NYC Schools chancellor

2001 - 2004 **KIPP FOUNDATION** – VP, School Development San Francisco, CA
- Managed school development, recruiting, and facilities for the largest network of charter schools in U.S.
- Led training for new school founders in negotiations and power mapping

1994 - 1996 **ATLANTA COMMITTEE FOR THE OLYMPIC GAMES (ACOG)** – Assistant to the COO Atlanta, GA
- ACOG hosted the largest peacetime event in world history
- Staffed up, then served on the Main Operations Center team
- Managed ACOG ground operations during response to Olympic Park bombing

1992 - 1994 **CASADY SCHOOL** – Mathematics, Spanish Language Faculty, Middle Division Oklahoma City, OK
- Nominated by graduating class to present commencement address
- Coached baseball, basketball, football, math teams

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OTHER DATA

- Co-chair, New Orleans Community Lighthouse solar and battery-storage microgrid project
- Member, City of New Orleans Electric Transportation Roadmap Project Working Group
- Mentor, McMain High School robotics team
- Student advisor, Lepage Center Founders Forum at Tulane
- Active advisor to multiple energy and education companies
- Former board chair: Louisiana Association of Public Charter Schools, Baton Rouge, LA; Rooted School, New Orleans, LA; NOLA Micro Schools, New Orleans, LA
- Former board member: KIPP Summit Academy, San Lorenzo, CA; Langston Hughes Academy, New Orleans, LA; Building Excellent Schools, Boston, MA; Cowen Institute at Tulane, New Orleans, LA
- Speaker, Future Louisiana, Leaders for a Better Louisiana, Baton Rouge, LA, 2025
- Speaker, Future of Energy Forum at Tulane University, 2024, 2025
- Speaker, Education Research Alliance for New Orleans, Tulane University, 2015
- Speaker, TEDxTU, 2010
- Speaker, Entrepreneurship in Education Reform, Harvard Business School, 2007
- Most Creative + Most Prepared Negotiator, Kellogg School at Northwestern, 1997

OTHER EDUCATION

- Big Couch Improv Comedy, New Orleans, LA
- Rocky Mountain School of Photography, Atlanta, GA
- Fuller Moto Welding Essentials, Atlanta, GA
- Racial Equity Institute, New Orleans, LA
- Center for Restorative Approaches, New Orleans, LA
- On Deck Climate Tech Fellowship, Remote
- La Montaña Language School, Bariloche, Argentina
- School for Contemplative Living, New Orleans, LA

PUBLICATIONS/MEDIA

- Matt's Leadership Toolkit, Substack, 2025.
- What NASA can teach us about education reform, The Big Think, 2019.
- Candler, Matt. "Go Small or Go Home: Innovation in Schooling." Educational Entrepreneurship Today, edited by Richard Hess and Michael McShane, Harvard Education Press, 2016.
- Candler, Matt. "A New Path to Rapid Reform for Districts and States." Hopes, Fears, & Reality: A Balanced Look at American Charter Schools in 2011, edited by Robin Lake, University of Washington, Center on Reinventing Public Education, 2012.
- Candler, Matt. "Supply-Side Reform on the Ground." The Future of Educational Entrepreneurship. edited by Richard Hess, Harvard Education Press, 2008.